ETCSL 1.4.1 — Inana's descent to the nether world

- **Editors:** ETCSL project (J. Black, G. Zólyomi, G. Cunningham, E. Robson, J. Ebeling), Oxford 1998–2006; composite after Civil 1989 and Krecher 1996 (electronic), translation after Black 1997 (electronic). Earlier editions listed in the XML header: **Sladek 1974** (PhD, Johns Hopkins: composite, score, commentary), Kramer 1980, Alster 1983, 1996, 1999 (score), Jacobsen 1987, Bottéro and Kramer 1989, Römer 1993.
- **URLs:** transliteration https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=c.1.4.1 ; translation https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=t.1.4.1 ; ORACC epsd2/literary **Q000343** (lemmatised, with morph: `../../ORACC/epsd2-literary--Q000343--Inanas-Descent/`).
- **Retrieved:** 2026-10-21 from the local OTA 2518 bulk corpus (`../_bulk/etcsl.zip`, members `etcsl/transliterations/c.1.4.1.xml`, `etcsl/translations/t.1.4.1.xml`).
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Content

412 composite lines + 28 pluses of single manuscripts (13A–13H, 30A–31A, 37A, 129A–B, 174A–B, 175A–B, 221A, 226A, 300A–301A, 305A–C, 319A, 325A, 376A, 379A) = 440 entries. Inana abandons her temples and descends (1–25, with her seven *me* and her garments); her instructions to Ninšubur (26–72); the gatekeeper Neti and Ereškigal (73–127); the seven gates and the stripping (128–164); Inana judged, killed and hung on a hook (165–172); Ninšubur's mourning and the appeals to Enlil, Nanna and Enki (173–221); Enki creates the *kurĝara* and the *galatur* from the dirt under his fingernails and gives them the plant and the water of life (222–253); Ereškigal in labour, the two creatures' sympathy, the corpse revived (254–281); Inana must give a substitute; the *galla* demons (282–305); Ninšubur, Šara and Lulal spared (306–347); Dumuzid found enthroned and handed over (348–367); his prayer to Utu and escape as a snake (368–381); the end of the story, fragmentary: Inana weeps, the fly, the decree – half the year for Dumuzid, half for his sister (382–410); doxology to Ereškigal (411–412).

Files

- `c.1.4.1.xml`, `t.1.4.1.xml` — ETCSL TEI source.
- `transliteration.md` (440 entries), `translation.md` (ETCSL's English prose by paragraph) — `../../../tools/etcsl2md.py`.

Manuscripts

About 45 OB tablets and fragments (Nibru, Urim, unprovenanced; list in the XML header).

Line numbering

ETCSL composite = ORACC Q000343 = Sladek 1974 (ORACC writes 13Š for ETCSL 13C, `š` for the letter C; checked by `העולם-התחתון/netherworld_tools.py`). The literature (Jacobsen, Bottéro–Kramer) cites the same numbers.

Usefulness

Base text (rank 1) for `העולם-התחתון/2-ירידת-אינאנה/`. The ETCSL translation is the rank-3 check. Sladek 1974 and the later critical work (Katz 2003, *The Image of the Netherworld in the Sumerian Sources*; Lapinkivi 2004) are not available here.